

Business Plan Workbook

For Fashion Brands

This PDF is built to be used, not admired. Fill the blanks, test the assumptions, and update it as you learn.

Goal: turn your idea into a clear plan you can execute, measure, and improve.

Version 2 — updated with how/when to use a business plan, distribution (place), simplified market research, and improved table wrapping.

0. How to use a business plan (and when you need one)

Most plans fail because they are written to sound smart, not to drive decisions. Your plan is a **tool**:

- **Alignment:** get founders, partners, and suppliers on the same page.
- **Decision-making:** force trade-offs (pricing, channels, inventory, cash).
- **Execution:** turn goals into weekly actions with owners and targets.
- **Risk control:** define early warning signs so you can react before it's too late.

How to use this workbook

- 1 Start with Sections 2–3 (customer + positioning). If you can't explain who you serve and why they buy, the rest is fantasy.
- 2 Then do Sections 4–6 (offer, operations, marketing). If your offer can't be produced, delivered, and sold profitably, it doesn't matter how cool it is.
- 3 Finally do Section 7 (financials). Numbers reveal the truth: margins, cash gaps, and break-even.
- 4 Update monthly. A plan is a living document; your assumptions will change after real sales.

When you need a business plan

- You are spending real money (inventory, ads, rent) and need to avoid dumb mistakes.
- You're adding a co-founder, investor, or partner and need alignment + accountability.
- You're scaling: new products, higher MOQs, hiring, or moving into retail/wholesale.
- You're applying for a loan, grant, or onboarding a distributor.

If you are only testing an idea, keep it lean: a 1-page plan + a 30-day test is enough. Don't hide behind paperwork.

1. Executive Summary

Write this last, but place it first. It's the story of the business in one page: what you sell, who you sell to, why they buy, how you deliver, and how you make money.

Question	Your answer (1–2 sentences)
Brand in one line	_____
Target customer	_____
Core problem	_____
Your promise / outcome	_____
What you sell (SKUs)	_____
Price range and margin target	_____
Main acquisition channel	_____
Place (where you sell)	_____
Operations model (make-to-stock / preorder / hybrid)	_____
12-month goal (revenue / profit)	_____

Reality check: if you can't answer these in plain language, you don't have a plan yet.

2. Customer and Positioning

Your brand is a position in the customer's mind. Positioning is not your logo; it's why a specific person buys from you instead of alternatives.

2.1 Ideal customer profile (ICP)

Item	Notes / fill-in
Customer type	Men / women / kids • age range • lifestyle
Demographics	Age: ____ • Gender: ____ • City/area: ____ • Income: ____ • Job/student: ____
Psychographics	Identity, values, interests, style inspiration, communities they follow
Buying behavior	Where they shop • how often • average spend • online vs offline • decision triggers
Pain points	Fit issues, sizing confusion, poor quality, boring designs, slow delivery, lack of trust, etc.
Top 3 reasons they would buy from you	1) ____ 2) ____ 3) ____

2.2 Value proposition

Prompt	Your answer
For (customer)	_____
Who struggles with (problem)	_____
We offer (product)	_____
That delivers (outcome)	_____
Unlike (alternatives)	_____
Because (proof)	_____

3. Market Research (simple)

Market research is not a Wikipedia report. It's evidence that real people want this and will pay.

3.1 What to validate

- Demand: do enough people want this style at this price?
- Competition: who already wins in this space and why?
- Customer truth: what makes them buy (and what blocks them)?
- Channel truth: can you reach them reliably (without burning cash)?

3.2 Customer research notes

Do 10 interviews before you produce. Ask about their last purchase, not their opinion.

Topic	What you learned (short bullets)
What they bought last (brand / item / price)	_____
Why they chose it	_____
What they hated / returned	_____
What would make them switch brands	_____
Where they discovered the brand	_____

3.3 Competitive map

List 5–10 competitors your customer already follows or buys from. Then answer: why would they switch to you?

Competitor	Price	Strength	Weakness you exploit	Your counter-positioning
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

3.4 Market size (optional)

If you need investors, loans, or you're picking a big direction, estimate market size. If not, skip it and focus on sales.

TAM = everyone who could buy (total addressable market). **SAM** = the part you can realistically reach (serviceable available market). **SOM** = what you can win in 12–24 months (serviceable obtainable market).

Metric	Simple way to estimate
TAM	# of target people in your country x average yearly spend on your category
SAM	TAM x % you can reach (your cities, your language, your channel access)
SOM	SAM x realistic share (start tiny: 0.1%–1% depending on your stage)

4. Offer, Pricing, and Place (Distribution)

You don't sell "a brand". You sell specific SKUs at specific prices through specific channels.

4.1 What you sell (SKU plan)

SKU	Customer benefit	Target price	Target gross margin	Notes
_____	_____	_____ EGP	_____ %	_____
_____	_____	_____ EGP	_____ %	_____
_____	_____	_____ EGP	_____ %	_____

4.2 Pricing logic (quick)

Price is not a guess. It is: **cost + margin + what the market accepts**. If you can't hit margins, change the product, supplier, or channel.

Item	Value
Unit cost (COGS)	_____ EGP
Packaging + fulfillment	_____ EGP
Payment fees	_____ EGP / %
Returns allowance	_____ %
Target gross margin	_____ %
Final selling price	_____ EGP

4.3 Place (where you will sell)

Distribution is the difference between a hobby and a business. Choose channels that match your cash, time, and trust level.

Channel	Why this channel	What you need to win	Risks / cost
Instagram + WhatsApp	Fast trust + direct selling	Daily content, fast replies, clear sizing, delivery process	Time heavy; messy operations
Website (Shopify)	Scalable checkout + data	Good product pages, traffic source, payments, delivery	Needs traffic and conversion work
Marketplaces	Built-in demand	Competitive pricing, strong reviews, fast fulfillment	Fees; price wars
Pop-ups / events	High trust; instant feedback	Great display, stock planning, staff	Upfront cost; limited time
Retail / wholesale	Volume if you have proven sellers	Consistent quality, lead time, terms, margins	Cashflow risk; lower margins

5. Operations and Production

Operations is where most fashion brands die: cash trapped in inventory, supplier delays, and quality issues.

5.1 Production model (inventory strategy)

- **Make-to-stock:** faster shipping, higher cash risk.
- **Pre-order:** lower inventory risk, slower delivery, higher trust requirement.
- **Hybrid:** stock bestsellers, pre-order risky styles.

5.2 Production process type (how you manufacture)

Pick the process type that matches your product variety and volume:

Type	Definition	Best when	Common mistakes
Job production	One-off or highly customized items made per order.	Custom pieces, tailoring, low volume, high variety.	Unclear specs; time overruns; pricing too low.
Batch production	Items made in groups (batches) before switching to another style/size.	Most small fashion brands; drops; limited runs.	Batch size too big; cash locked; no sell-through data.
Flow production	Continuous standardized production with steady throughput.	High volume, stable demand, few SKUs.	Trying flow too early; quality drifts; high overhead.

5.3 Vendor and factory selection

- **Capabilities:** fabric, printing, embroidery, wash, pattern making.
- **MOQ and lead time:** match your cash and drop cadence.
- **Quality control:** define measurable acceptance criteria (stitching, sizing tolerance, color).
- **Terms:** deposit %, payment timing, rework rules, penalties.

QC checkpoint	What you measure	Pass/fail rule
Sample approval	Fit, fabric handfeel, color	No production until approved
In-line inspection	Stitching, measurements	Reject if > _____ defects per batch
Final inspection	Packaging, labels, finishing	Reject if defects exceed _____ %
Returns analysis	Return reasons tracking	Fix top 2 reasons every month

5.4 Fulfillment and customer support

- **Shipping promise:** clear timeline and tracking.

- **Exchange/return policy:** simple and visible.
- **Support SLA:** reply time targets and escalation path.
- **Size guide:** reduce returns by making sizing idiot-proof.

6. Marketing and Sales

Marketing is not posting. It's a system: message → channel → offer → conversion → repeat.

6.1 Your funnel

Stage	What the customer does	Your assets	KPI
Awareness	Sees you	Reels, collabs, ads	Reach, saves, profile visits
Interest	Follows / joins	Bio link, landing page, WhatsApp	Follower-to-lead %
Consideration	Asks questions	Highlights, size guide, FAQs	DM-to-checkout %
Purchase	Buys	Checkout, payment, delivery	Conversion rate, AOV
Repeat	Buys again	Drops, email/WhatsApp, loyalty	Repeat rate, LTV

6.2 Weekly content and outreach plan

If you want growth, you need volume plus feedback loops. Build a weekly plan you can sustain for 90 days.

Activity	Weekly target	Owner	Notes
Reels posted	_____	_____	Test 3 hooks per week
Stories	_____	_____	Daily: social proof + behind scenes
DM outreach	_____	_____	Follow-up is where sales happen
Influencer outreach	_____	_____	Track replies and conversion
Customer interviews	_____	_____	10 interviews beats guessing

7. Financials (simple but real)

If the numbers don't work, the business is just content. Keep this section brutally honest.

7.1 Unit economics (per order)

Item	Value
Average order value (AOV)	_____ EGP
COGS (products)	_____ EGP
Packaging + delivery	_____ EGP
Payment fees	_____ EGP
Marketing cost per order (blended)	_____ EGP
Gross profit per order	_____ EGP

7.2 Break-even

Metric	Formula / target
Monthly fixed costs	Rent + salaries + tools + overhead
Contribution margin per order	AOV - variable costs
Break-even orders / month	Fixed costs / contribution margin
Break-even revenue / month	Break-even orders x AOV

7.3 Cash flow sanity check

Fashion kills you with cash gaps: you pay suppliers before you get customer money. Track it.

Month	Cash in	Cash out	Net	End cash
1	_____	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____	_____

8. Milestones and 90-Day Execution Plan

A plan without milestones is fantasy. Tie milestones to measurable outputs, not feelings.

8.1 12-month milestones

Month	Milestone	Metric / proof
1	First validated product concept	10 customer interviews + preorder interest
2	Samples approved	Fit and quality signed off
3	First drop launched	X orders, Y conversion rate
6	Repeat purchases start	Repeat rate >= _____ %
12	Sustainable growth	Monthly profit >= _____ EGP

8.2 90-day plan (weekly)

Week	Key focus	Deliverables	Metric
1	Customer research + offer	10 interviews, competitor list, SKU shortlist	Interview count, shortlist done
2	Sampling + supplier	Supplier selected, sample ordered, QC criteria drafted	Sample ETA, QC checklist
3	Content engine	10 reels batch, highlights, size guide draft	Content volume, profile visits
4	Preorder / launch test	Landing + preorder or drop plan	Leads, conversion

9. Risks and Mitigation

A risk list is only useful if each risk has an owner and an early warning sign.

Risk	Early warning	Mitigation / decision	Owner
Cash runs out before product-market fit	Low conversion and slow repeat rate	Reduce SKUs, switch to preorder, cut fixed costs, raise prices, shorten lead time	_____
Quality issues increase returns	Return rate > _____ %	Tight QC, fix sizing, improve product info, analyze top return reasons weekly	_____
Marketing channel stops working	Reach down 30%+ or CPM spikes	Diversify: influencer, community, paid tests, email/WhatsApp list	_____
Supplier delays	Lead time slips or missed milestones	Second supplier, buffer time, clear penalties, smaller batches	_____
Copycats	Similar designs appear	Differentiate via brand story, fit, community, speed, limited drops	_____

If you can't name an owner, it's not a risk. It's a complaint.

10. Appendix: Assumptions and Links

Keep a record of your assumptions so you can replace guesses with facts.

Assumption	Value	How you will validate	Date
Conversion rate	_____ %	Track website/DM conversion for 30 days	_____
Return rate	_____ %	Measure returns after first 50 orders	_____
Lead time	_____ days	Confirm with supplier in writing	_____
Gross margin	_____ %	Finalize costing sheet after sampling	_____